snapped – broke / cut

seclusion – isolation

bedlam – noisy confusion

perched – sat / rested

rebukes – scoldings

dilapidated – damaged

pallor – an unhealthy pale appearance

shroud – cloth used to wrap a dead person

1. Answer the following questions in one or two sentences based on your understanding of the story.

a. Describe the grandfather as seen in the portrait.

b. Why was the author left with his grandmother in the village?

c. Where did the author study in his childhood?

d. Why did the grandmother accompany the author to school?

e. What made the dogs follow the grandmother after school hours?

f. Why didn't the grandmother feel sentimental when the author went abroad for higher education?

g. What was the happiest time of the day for grandmother?

2. Answer the following questions in three or four sentences each.

a. Describe the author's grandmother.

b. What was the daily routine of the grandmother at home?

c. How is school education in the village different from that in the city?

d. The grandmother appreciated the value of education. Give instances in support of your answer.

e. The grandmother was strong-minded. Justify.

f. How did the grandmother spend the last few hours of her life?

3. Answer the following in a paragraph of 100 - 150 words each.

a) The grandmother played a vital role in the author's formative years. Give your own example of how elders have a positive influence on the younger generation. Include examples from the story also.

b) As young Khushwant Singh, write a letter to your parents describing your daily routine expressing your thoughts and feelings about staying in the village.

c) Animals are capable of empathy. Substantiate this statement with examples from the story as well as your own experiences.

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